

Airtel and MS launch combo plan

Airtel and Microsoft have tied up to launch special Airtel Broadband plan with Xbox 360 for customers in the main metro cities until 30th June, 2013. <http://dgit.in/13wZU3i>



32GB Nexus 7 on Play Store

Google has put up the Nexus 7 32GB Wi-fi only model on sale on the Play Store for ₹18,999 <http://dgit.in/ZvIXb2>

LETTER OF THE MONTH

✉ I'm still an avid reader of Digit but a few things really bothered me in this month's issue.

1. Do you have anybody spying on Microsoft? How did you come to know that the next version of Windows would be christened 'Windows 9'? It may be 'Windows Ultra', 'Windows Bizarre'...or anything under the sun! If you agree with this, why were you so eager to publish the cover page with the name 'Windows 9'? Was it to raise your sales? Come on guys, you people are doing good! Relax!
2. I don't support the idea that Windows 8 is a failure. I purchased the online version on December 12 and I'm happy. Windows 7 is a pretty stable and user friendly version, yes, but Windows 8 is here for good. You, in your article have not even cared to mention the good stuff you have in Windows 8: Client Hyper-V, mount any image by default, support to dot net 4 by default, bitlocker by default... only to name a few. When I was going through your article, all the criticism on Windows 8 sounded like the usual ones I face in office by a bunch of old guys not ready to embrace something new and are happy with Windows XP - not ready to budge a



- little, think differently and embrace new stuff! Come on guys, I expected you all to be much more versatile!
3. I agree that Microsoft is making its users a bit too used to touch-enabled devices, but what's wrong with that? We don't embrace Linux because we're lazy but I believe in Closed Source because on another platform if someone knew the root password, they could change heaven into hell! I don't believe in Open Source. Take a look at what's happening with Java; despite being so popular, Norton is reporting that Java updates are not reliable any more even from the company site.
4. Please do some reviews on servers also. What about server OSes? What about supporting server OSes such as Microsoft Exchange Server? What about Mac? Think Digit, think.

Shubbankar Nath

📌 We reported what we found, and it's no coincidence that globally, tech experts agree with our views. As for no faith in Open Source... seriously? Linux may not be a popular desktop OS, but the server OSes you want us to look at... ruled by *nix! Android - open source... need we say more? We're not fanboys, and neither should you be one.

Robert

I prefer IE 10 over Chrome. The Windows 8 store also provides a great deal of apps which wasn't present in the earlier one. What about compatibility issues, you ask? When I find one, I run it in Windows 7 mode. Windows 8 lets you search - not only in your PC but also in the search apps or your apps such as Google search, Bing, etc. This wasn't there in Windows 7. The most important thing is shutdown speed. Booting and shutdown is faster than with any other Windows OS. Moreover, Microsoft didn't remove the traditional Windows totally so that Windows 7 users don't have much problem using 8. I do miss the Start

button, but not completely since if I point to the bottom-left corner of my screen I can see a start icon, which upon clicking directly takes you to the Start screen where you can directly search for an app, file, settings or anything else (without opening the charms bar). If you've used Windows 7 frequently, you'll be able to adapt to 8. It's very easy to use, fast and fluid. In this version, the snap left and right options are of great use when you're using two apps at once (The video app in this mode is really attractive). The People app lets you post your views directly (update status and post to Twitter) and the messaging app lets you chat with

your Facebook friends and Live groups (it would have been better if Windows had included a large number of social networks and numbers (SMS) in it). I've been using it since three months and I think it's just right for me and techno-geeks. The Windows apps don't let you get bored. You don't have to surf the whole web for the news, weather, travel, finance etc., you get everything on your Start button without running it separately. Moreover, the menu bar in the file explorer really provides many handy tools to use when you're in a hurry. According to me, Windows 8 is better than Windows 7. But I really liked your review on "How to make start button visible". That was really good and I liked that idea.

Last but not the least, keep on bringing out the latest reviews so that I can use my spare time efficiently. You won't believe it but I prefer reading Digit over using my Android smartphone.

Kaushik Ghosh

📌 Since you've invested your hard earned cash on your Windows 8 purchase, you might be suffering from a buyer's bias. No no, we kid you Kaushik. Your point about Explorer getting the new ribbon is perfectly valid, but don't you think it falls in the "about time, Microsoft" category? And yes, people ought to give IE another chance. As for your point about the app store, traditionally for Windows (as the most popular OS on the planet) the entire internet (in turn, any app you discover in the wild) was your app store. About apps snapping into place, yes those Metro apps designed with that functionality will do it well, but Windows 7 too had aero snap if you remember. And you were not even restricted to the 20:80 ratio. When working with multiple programs (notice we're not calling them apps), Windows 7, we find gives you much better window management; at least for serious work. Sure for checking weather or your social feed (tablety stuff) the modern UI is just about fine. The dichotomy is what's troubling. At the end of the day however there's no escaping the vision Microsoft has laid down for us, and since you've made the switch without too much teething trouble, we old-timers will look at you for inspiration! Thanks for writing in.

Siddharth